



# Individual Teaching Assistant Report Spring 2025 for ECO 420K - MICROECONOMIC THEORY (34700, 34705) (Maria Teresa Sarmiento)

Project Title: **Course Evaluations Spring 2025**

Courses Audience: **183**

Responses Received: **39**

Response Ratio: **21.3%**

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## Report Comments

### Guide to the Interpretation of Course Evaluations at UT Austin

The goal of course evaluation process at UT Austin is to drive teaching excellence and to support continuous improvement in teaching and learning experiences. The two sets of scales used for core evaluation questions and the associated weights are:

Strongly Agree (5)  
Agree (4)  
Neutral (3)  
Disagree (2)  
Strongly Disagree (1)

Excellent (5)  
Very Good (4)  
Satisfactory (3)  
Unsatisfactory (2)  
Very Unsatisfactory (1)

The Mean is calculated by adding all of the weights for a single question and dividing by the number of respondents. The course workload question is not averaged.

The number of students (e.g. respondents) marking each option is reported for each of the items. These frequency distributions provide information about the level of student ratings and the spread and shape of the class distribution of responses. The distributions thus provide a picture of student perception of a course.

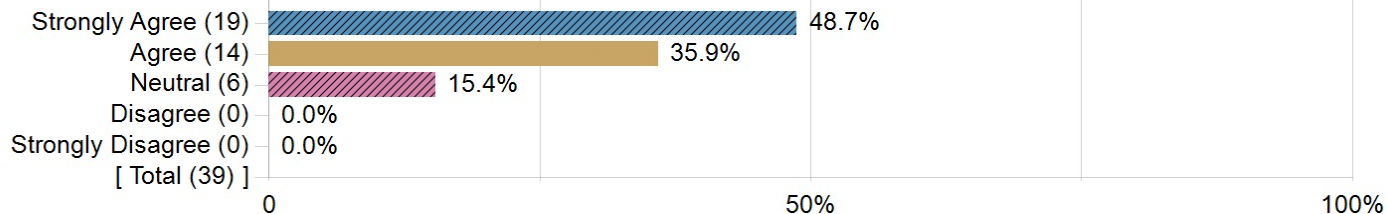
Course evaluations provide snapshots of student perspectives on their course-level learning experiences. Most experts on teaching evaluation advise that no individual method gives the complete picture of an instructor's teaching effectiveness; multiple and diverse measures, on multiple occasions, are advised to give a full picture of the teaching effectiveness of a particular instructor. Moreover, other factors, such as size of class, level of the class, and content of the course, can cause small variations in the ratings. Therefore, student perspectives for a particular instructor or course should be interpreted as a snapshot, and not as providing complete information on the teaching effectiveness of that instructor.

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Creation Date: **Wednesday, June 11, 2025**

## Teaching Assistant Questions

The TA was available to help me as needed.



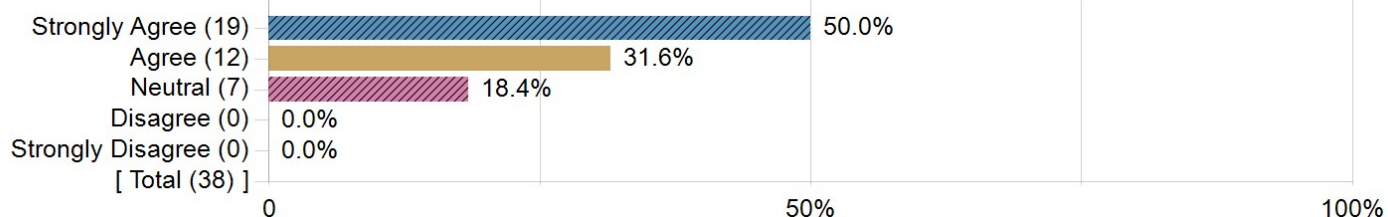
Statistics

Value

Mean

4.33

I felt the TA was approachable.



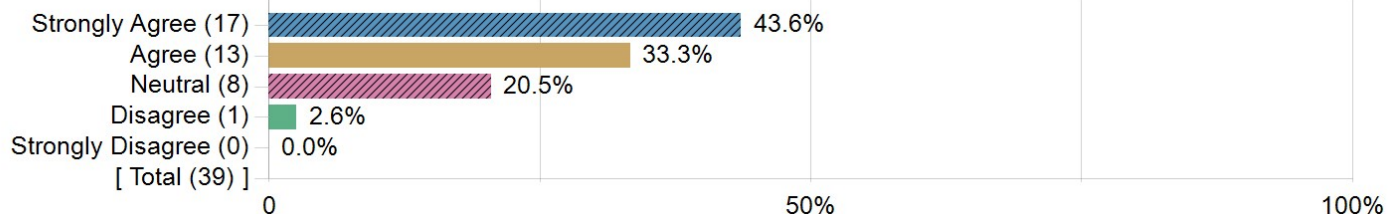
Statistics

Value

Mean

4.32

The TA explained course concepts, subject matter, or other course-related topics in a way that helped me learn.



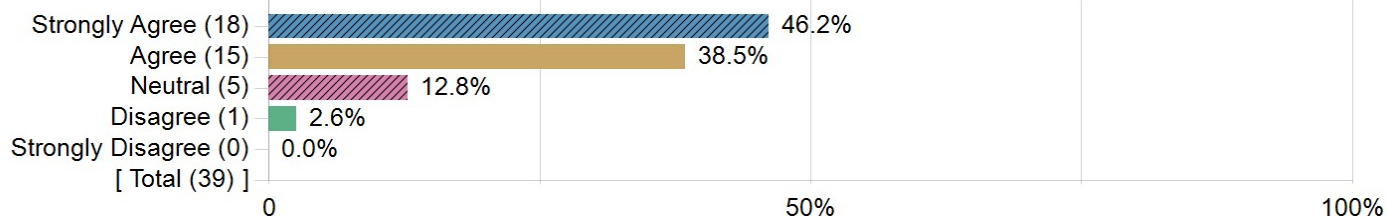
Statistics

Value

Mean

4.18

The TA was able to address most of my questions related to the course concepts, subject -matter, or topics.



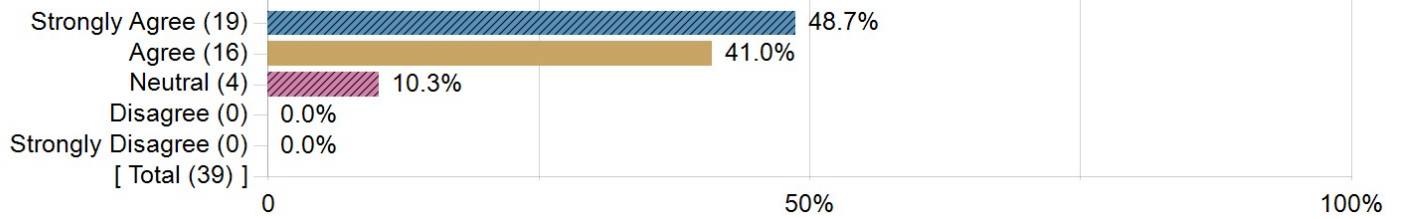
Statistics

Value

Mean

4.28

## The TA communicated course content and subject matter with accuracy.



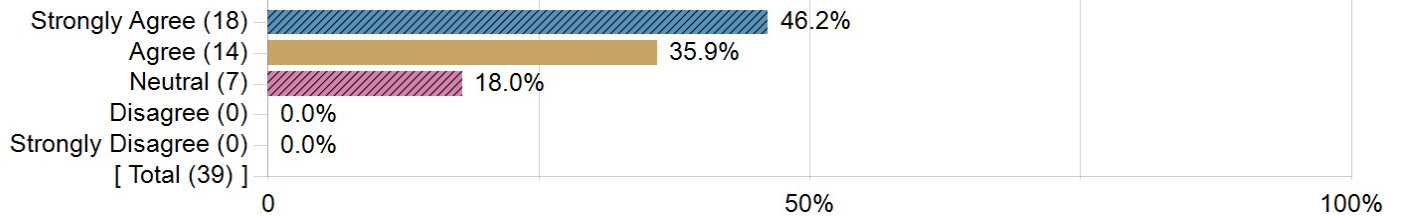
Statistics

Value

Mean

4.38

## The TA communicated course expectations and instructions clearly.



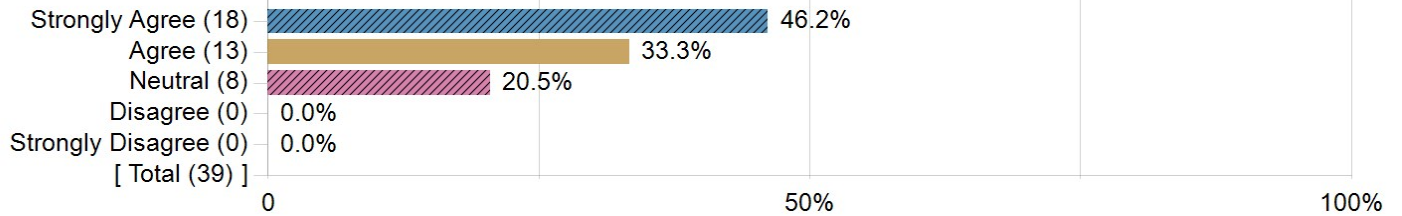
Statistics

Value

Mean

4.28

## The TA appeared engaged throughout the course experience.



Statistics

Value

Mean

4.26

## Comment Questions

**Identify aspects of your interactions with your teaching assistant that were most effective in helping your learning.**

| Comments                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                 |
|----------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------|
| My TA let discussion sections once per week that were very helpful in assisting with the difficult problem sets we has in class.                                                                                                                         |
| She hosts the 9 am problem sessions and works through the problem set which is so helpful!                                                                                                                                                               |
| The discussion sections were very helpful in understanding where I could have gone wrong on the problem sets.                                                                                                                                            |
| all                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                      |
| n/a                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                      |
| She was available with many office hours.                                                                                                                                                                                                                |
| The TA's were always available and constantly made announcements in canvas to notify study times and availability.                                                                                                                                       |
| n                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                        |
| During the friday section, she would go over our practice tests.                                                                                                                                                                                         |
| I really appreciated how engaged Maria was and how she kept giving the TA sessions a lot of effort even though only 2–3 people would come each week. I also really liked how she explained concepts. I felt that she was very approachable and friendly. |
| Helpful in working through problems                                                                                                                                                                                                                      |
| Never went to office hours                                                                                                                                                                                                                               |
| I found the office hours helpful.                                                                                                                                                                                                                        |
| NA                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                       |
| N/A                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                      |
| NA                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                       |
| n/a                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                      |

**What is one thing the teaching assistant could do differently to help improve future students' learning in this course?**

| Comments                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                             |
|--------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------|
| Maria did an amazing job as TA. I would only suggest that before each discussion section she could ask the class which problems they had the most struggles with to then spend more time on those specific problems rather than giving each problem roughly the same amount of time. |
| nothing                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                              |
| I can't really think of anything.                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                    |
| none                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                 |
| n/a                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                  |
| Nothing                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                              |
| n/a                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                  |
| n                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                    |
| Maybe help do a session before the homework is due so we can have help on it.                                                                                                                                                                                                        |
| Nothing, she was great!                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                              |
| More availability                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                    |
| Never went to office hours                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                           |
| N/A                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                  |
| NA                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                   |
| N/A                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                  |
| NA                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                   |
| n/a                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                  |